

HORMONES OF ADRENAL CORTEX

- **Adrenocortical hormones are steroids in nature:**

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- **Hence name 'Corticosteroids'**

- **Based on their functions, 3 groups :—**

- a. Mineralocorticoids

- b. Glucocorticoids

- c. Sex hormones

1. MINERALOCORTICIDS

- **Corticosteroids that act on minerals (electrolytes)**, particularly Na^+ & K^+ .

- **Mineralocorticoids are :—**

- a. Aldosterone

- b. 11-Deoxycorticosterone

- **Secreted by:** Zona glomerulosa of adrenal cortex.

- **Aldosterone (Life-saving hormone):**

- Maintains osmolarity and volume of ECF.

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- Its absence causes **death within 3 days – 2 weeks**.

2. GLUCOCORTICIDS

- **Glucocorticoids act mainly on glucose metabolism.**

- **These are :—**

- a. Cortisol

- b. Corticosterone

- c. Cortisone

- **Secreted mainly by:** Zona fasciculata of adrenal cortex.

3. ADRENAL SEX HORMONES

- **Secreted mainly by:** Zona reticularis.
- **These are :—**
 - a. **Male sex hormones (Androgens):**
 - i. Testosterone
 - ii. Androstenedione
 - iii. Dehydroepiandrosterone
 - b. **Estrogen** } (*small quantity*)
 - c. **Progesterone** } (*small quantity*)